

(b) Diagrams and representations

Students should be taught, as appropriate, to construct, draw, use and understand:

the need for correct and precise labelling of all forms of diagrams;

pictograms, bar charts, multiple or composite bar charts and pie charts for qualitative, quantitative and discrete data;

vertical line (stick) graphs for discrete data;

for continuous data the following: pie charts, grouped frequency diagrams with equal class intervals, frequency diagrams, cumulative frequency diagrams, population pyramids;

stem and leaf diagrams for discrete and continuous data;

scatter diagrams for bivariate data;

line graphs and time series;

The labelling and scaling of axes will be expected.

The reasons for choosing one form of representation will be expected.

Comparative line graphs will be expected.

No distinction will be made between cumulative frequency polygons and curves whilst frequency polygons could be open or closed.

Students may need to define the stem for themselves. A key will be expected.

Students may be required to define their own scales.

Trend lines by eye and seasonal variation will be expected.

Content

choropleth maps (shading);

simple properties of the shape of distributions of data including symmetry, positive and negative skew;

the distinction between well presented and poorly presented data;

the shape and simple properties of frequency distributions; symmetrical positive and negative skew;

the potential for visual misuse, by omission or misrepresentation;

the transformation from one presentation to another;

how to discover errors in data and recognise data that do not fit a general trend or pattern.

Notes

Eg showing temperature across Europe by shading regions.

Poorly presented data can be misleading.

Knowing about causes such as unrepresentative scales will be expected.

Bar chart to pie chart, etc.

Analytical definition of an outlier will not be required.